

Radial Linear Nonadiabatic Analysis in MESA/star Discretization, Convection Closures, and Diagnostics

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Abstract

This document specifies the radial linear nonadiabatic operator in MESA/star. Section 2 pairs each model equation with its colored linearized row and source routine. It distinguishes the velocity grids, energy forms, pressure work, and RSP2, TDC, frozen-flux, and static MLT closures. RSP2 solves independent face superadiabaticity and cell turbulent velocity, using shared TDC lengths. The optional three equation model adds face entropy flux and variance to the turbulence evolution system; the default model retains its signed algebraic convection closure. The appendices retain closure details, work diagnostics, and schema 130 export.

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1 Scope and conventions

The implementation is a MESA/star operator, not a wrapper around the RSP LINA matrix. RSP defines the comparison output and growth rate convention. The matrix rows use MESA/star variables and the residual branches listed below. MESA/star indexes the surface with $k = 1$ and the innermost cell with $k = N \equiv \texttt{s\%nz}$. The normal mode convention is

$$\delta q_k(t) = \hat{q}_k e^{\sigma t}, \quad \sigma = \gamma + i\omega. \quad (1)$$

A positive γ is unstable. For $\omega > 0$, the period is

$$\Pi = \frac{2\pi}{\omega}. \quad (2)$$

The base perturbation variables in each zone are

$$\mathbf{x}_k = (\delta \ln \rho, \delta \ln r, \delta v_{\text{rad}}, \delta \ln T, \delta L)_k. \quad (3)$$

Here v_{rad} is the face variable v or the cell variable u , according to the active hydro momentum equation. RSP2 adds cell δw and face δY_{face} , with $e_t = w^2$. Its face pressure scale height is derived, not an independent unknown. With `RSP2_use_3equation_model`, RSP2 also evolves face $\text{Pi} = \langle v'_r s' \rangle$ and $\text{Phi} = \langle s'^2 \rangle$. These roman names denote the code variables; they are distinct from period Π and gravitational potential Φ below. Active TDC adds an internal δw variable used only by LNA; it does not add a persistent variable to the normal star solver. In the TDC formulas below, this internal amplitude is written as $A = v_c / \sqrt{2/3}$ to distinguish it from RSP2 w .

1.1 Equation key and notation

The colored equations are the rows assembled into the global eigenproblem:

- **Blue: dynamic row.** $\delta F = \sigma \delta Q$ contributes to both matrix sides.
- **Rust: algebraic row.** $\delta G = 0$ has a zero row on the time-derivative side.

Each box keeps the model equation and its linearization together. The row labels also identify the type without color. Unboxed equations give coefficients, local closures, thermodynamic comparisons, or output quantities; they do not add independent rows to the global system.

In linearized equations, all unperturbed coefficients are evaluated at the static background. Mass and composition are fixed. The symbol δ denotes the complex mode amplitude; the common factor $e^{\sigma t}$ is omitted. For any AD quantity f ,

$$\delta f = \sum_j \left. \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_j} \right|_0 \delta x_j. \quad (4)$$

Thus a term such as δU_q or δL_c includes the full supported AD response of its closure, not only its explicit velocity dependence. Fixed background row scales are suppressed in the displayed equations; they multiply every term in a row and do not change its solutions. Use $\mathcal{A}_k = 4\pi r_k^2$ for face area and $\mathcal{V}_k$ for cell volume. The convection amplitude A and the matrix $\mathbf{A}$ are distinct.

The five base rows are density, radius, momentum, energy, and transport. Perturbed TDC adds one convection row; RSP2 adds a turbulent-energy row and a face-flux row, with two further moment rows in its optional three equation model. Boundary conditions and forced-zero constraints replace the indicated rows. They do not increase the number of unknowns.

1.2 Independent choices in the operator

The velocity grid and the energy form are separate choices. With `u_flag`, the velocity unknown is cell-centered u and the face velocity is reconstructed. Otherwise the LNA uses a face velocity unknown v , including on a background with `v_flag` off. This changes the momentum stencil and the face quantities used by radius and work; it does not select an energy form.

The `dedt` energy option is supported for all accepted convection paths. RSP2 also supports `eps_grav`, with either velocity grid. Within `dedt`, `use_P_d_1_div_rho_form_of_work` chooses both the work stencil and the energy inertia:

Work control	Pressure work	Energy differentiated in time
True	Cell $P d(1/\rho)/dt$	$e + E_t$
False	Face $P \mathcal{A} v_f$ flux difference	$e + E_t + K + \Phi$

Here E_t is the selected cell turbulent energy, K is specific kinetic energy, and Φ is specific gravitational potential energy. Section 2.4 gives the two substitutions in the same linearized energy row. The work control acts independently of velocity time centering. For RSP2 `eps_grav`, thermal storage and EOS compression enter through the entropy coefficients; turbulent storage and non-EOS local pressure work remain explicit. This form contains no kinetic or potential inertia, regardless of the work-control setting. Non-RSP2 LNA still requires `dedt`.

1.3 Envelope domain

Routine `setup_star_LNA_var_map` uses all N cells when `star_LNA_T_inner` is nonpositive. For a positive value, it retains the contiguous surface cells $1 \leq k \leq N_{\text{LNA}}$ whose temperatures do not exceed that limit. Selection stops at the first hotter cell and requires at least two active cells. The background mesh and stellar structure are retained.

The matrix contains only active variables. Routine `add_ad_partials_to_matrix` omits columns outside this domain, imposing $\delta q_k = 0$ for $k > N_{\text{LNA}}$. Coefficients at the cut still use the full-model background; the cut does not replace the physical inner boundary at N or set a new `R_center`. Output records both zone counts. A velocity kick sets the excluded core velocities to zero.

2 Equations and their linearization

Read Sections 2.1–2.5 for the five base rows. Then use the TDC row in Section 2.6, or the two RSP2 rows in Section 2.7, when that convection model is active. Section 2.9 gives the surface and forced-zero replacements. All rows refer to the same static background and mode vector.

2.1 Density: fixed cell mass

The cell volume is $\mathcal{V}_k = (4\pi/3)(r_k^3 - r_{k+1}^3)$.

Model equation.

$$\rho_k \mathcal{V}_k = \Delta m_k. \quad (5)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\delta \ln \rho_k + \frac{3r_k^3 \delta \ln r_k - 3r_{k+1}^3 \delta \ln r_{k+1}}{r_k^3 - r_{k+1}^3} = 0. \quad (6)$$

Code: `assemble_density_rows` and `cell_volume_for_star_LNA` in `star_LNA_support.f90`. At a fixed inner radius, its perturbation is zero. The same rule applies to columns below a temperature-selected envelope cut.

2.2 Radius: kinematics

The face velocity is $v_f = v$ on the face grid. With `u_flag`, v_f is the Riemann contact velocity reconstructed from cell velocity u .

Model equation.

$$\frac{d \ln r_k}{dt} = \frac{v_{f,k}}{r_k}. \quad (7)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\frac{\delta v_{f,k}}{r_k} = \sigma \delta \ln r_k. \quad (8)$$

Code: `assemble_radius_rows`. The background velocity is zero, so the product of its value with δr vanishes. The Riemann reconstruction remains differentiated: δv_f generally contains pressure, density, radius, and cell-velocity responses. It is not an arithmetic average of neighboring δu . At the surface, the reconstruction gives $v_{f,1} = u_1$. Appendix A.7 gives the contact-state formulas. For a cell constrained to zero velocity, the algebraic replacement is given in Section 2.9.

2.3 Momentum: the active velocity grid

Face velocity (v_flag, or the LNA face variable). Write $\Delta P_k = \Delta P_{\text{tot},k} + \Delta P_{\text{MLT},k}$, where $\Delta P_{\text{tot},k} = P_{\text{tot},k-1} - P_{\text{tot},k}$. The pressure closure is given in Appendix A and U_q in Appendix D.

Model equation.

$$\frac{dv_k}{dt} = -\frac{G_k m_{g,k}}{r_k^2} + U_{q,k} - \frac{\mathcal{A}_k}{\Delta m_{f,k}} \Delta P_k. \quad (9)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\left(\frac{2G_k m_{g,k}}{r_k^2} - \frac{2\mathcal{A}_k \Delta P_k}{\Delta m_{f,k}} \right) \delta \ln r_k + \delta U_{q,k} - \frac{\mathcal{A}_k}{\Delta m_{f,k}} \delta \Delta P_k = \sigma \delta v_k. \quad (10)$$

Code: `assemble_momentum_rows` and `momentum_rhs_for_star_LNA`. The face mass is fixed: $\Delta m_{f,k} = (\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)/2$ in the interior and $\Delta m_{f,1} = \Delta m_1/2$ at the surface.

Cell velocity (u_flag). Define the pressure, geometry, and gravity force sum

$$\mathcal{F}_{h,k} = P_{f,k+1} \mathcal{A}_{k+1} - P_{f,k} \mathcal{A}_k + P_k (\mathcal{A}_k - \mathcal{A}_{k+1}) + F_{g,k}. \quad (11)$$

Model equation.

$$\frac{du_k}{dt} = \frac{\mathcal{F}_{h,k}}{\Delta m_k} + U_{q,k}. \quad (12)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\frac{\delta \mathcal{F}_{h,k}}{\Delta m_k} + \delta U_{q,k} = \sigma \delta u_k. \quad (13)$$

Code: `eval_Riemann_dudt_rhs` in `hydro_riemann.f90`, called by `momentum_rhs_for_star_LNA`, followed by `Uq_cell_for_star_LNA`. For example, $\delta(P_f \mathcal{A}) = \mathcal{A} \delta P_f + 2P_f \mathcal{A} \delta \ln r$; all force terms are differentiated this way. Here P_k is the cell pressure used by the Riemann reconstruction, including its active turbulent-pressure terms. P_f is the reconstructed contact pressure, not an interpolation of EOS pressure alone. The gravity source is

$$F_{g,k} = -\frac{\Delta m_k}{2} \left(\frac{G_k m_k}{r_k^2} + \frac{G_{k+1} m_{k+1}}{r_{k+1}^2} \right), \quad k < N. \quad (14)$$

At $k = N$, only the first gravity contribution remains, the inward pressure flux is zero, and the geometry source is $P_N \mathcal{A}_N$, including when `R_center` > 0. At the surface, the outward momentum flux uses $P_{\text{bc}} \mathcal{A}_1$. Its pressure need not equal the surface pressure used in energy work.

The cell equation therefore changes both the force stencil and the reconstructed quantities; replacing the symbol v by u in the face equation would not give this row. Finite-step pressure and radius time centering is excluded. The separate cell eddy-viscosity source is described in Appendix D.

2.4 Energy: luminosity divergence, sources, and work

For `dedt`, both work choices use the following row, with different e_{eff} and $\mathcal{W}$ as specified below. Let $D_m L_k = (L_k - L_{k+1})/\Delta m_k$.

Model equation.

$$\frac{de_{\text{eff},k}}{dt} = -D_m L_k + \epsilon_k - \mathcal{W}_k. \quad (15)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$-D_m \delta L_k + \delta \epsilon_k - \delta \mathcal{W}_k = \sigma \delta e_{\text{eff},k}. \quad (16)$$

Code: `assemble_energy_rows`, `energy_rhs_for_star_LNA`, and `energy_inertia_for_star_LNA`. The thermal contribution is

$$\delta e_k = \rho_k \left(\frac{\partial e}{\partial \rho} \right)_T \delta \ln \rho_k + C_{V,k} T_k \delta \ln T_k. \quad (17)$$

The source ϵ contains the supported nuclear, neutrino, and fixed heating terms. Their implementation and the energy coefficients are given in Appendix A. The work formulas below define $\delta \mathcal{W}$ in this row; they are not additional global equations.

Local pressure work: internal plus turbulent energy. For `use_P_d_1_div_rho_form_of_work=.true.`, define the cell volume rate $\dot{V}_k = \mathcal{A}_k v_{f,k} - \mathcal{A}_{k+1} v_{f,k+1}$. Then

$$e_{\text{eff},k} = e_k + E_{t,k}, \quad \mathcal{W}_k^{\text{local}} = \frac{P_{c,k}}{\Delta m_k} \dot{V}_k, \quad (18)$$

$$\delta e_{\text{eff},k} = \delta e_k + \delta E_{t,k}, \quad \delta \mathcal{W}_k^{\text{local}} = \frac{P_{c,k,0}}{\Delta m_k} (\mathcal{A}_k \delta v_{f,k} - \mathcal{A}_{k+1} \delta v_{f,k+1}). \quad (19)$$

P_c is the cell work pressure from `dwork_dm_for_star_LNA`: the selected EOS/RSP2 pressure plus the MLT turbulent-pressure coefficient where enabled. The same $P_{c,k,0}$ multiplies both bounding volume fluxes. The nonlinear counterpart is `hydro_energy:eval_simple_PdV_work`.

On the full domain, mass conservation and the radius rows give

$$\frac{\delta \dot{V}_k}{\Delta m_k} = \sigma \delta(1/\rho_k) = -\frac{\sigma}{\rho_k} \delta \ln \rho_k. \quad (20)$$

Thus the work contribution can be moved to the inertia side as $-(P_{c,k,0}/\rho_k) \delta \ln \rho_k$ after eliminating the velocity divergence. The code retains that divergence in **A** and $\delta e + \delta E_t$ in **B**. It adds neither δK nor $\delta \Phi$ for this work choice.

Face pressure work: total energy. For `use_P_d_1_div_rho_form_of_work=.false.`, the paired choices are

$$e_{\text{eff},k} = e_k + E_{t,k} + K_k + \Phi_k, \quad (21)$$

$$\mathcal{W}_k^{\text{flux}} = \frac{P_{f,k}\mathcal{A}_k v_{f,k} - P_{f,k+1}\mathcal{A}_{k+1} v_{f,k+1}}{\Delta m_k}, \quad (22)$$

$$\delta e_{\text{eff},k} = \delta e_k + \delta E_{t,k} + \delta K_k + \delta \Phi_k, \quad (23)$$

$$\delta \mathcal{W}_k^{\text{flux}} = \frac{P_{f,k,0}\mathcal{A}_k \delta v_{f,k} - P_{f,k+1,0}\mathcal{A}_{k+1} \delta v_{f,k+1}}{\Delta m_k}. \quad (24)$$

Now the two work coefficients are different face pressures. On the face-velocity grid, `static_face_pressure_for_star_LNA` forms them from mass-weighted cell pressures and the selected MLT contribution. With `u_flag`, they are the background Riemann pressures `s%P_face_ad`. At the surface of the cell-velocity scheme, $P_{f,1} = P_{\text{eos},1}$ for energy work, even when the momentum boundary uses a different P_{bc} .

`mechanical_energy_inertia_for_star_LNA` adds the kinetic and potential derivatives only for `dedt` with this work control false. On a static background $\delta K = 0$, but $\delta \Phi$ is first order in the radius perturbations and must remain. Appendix A.3 gives the discrete energies for both velocity grids. Changing the work form therefore changes both $\mathcal{W}$ and e_{eff} . It is not a row rescaling, and the two discrete operators need not give identical modes. The pressure-gradient work represented by the face flux is paired with the mechanical energy derivatives.

Static limit, time centering, and boundaries. Both work forms use the same face velocity: the independent face variable for the face scheme, and the differentiated Riemann contact velocity for `u_flag`. Holding the work pressure at its background value does not freeze that contact-velocity response. At $v_{f,0} = 0$,

$$\delta(P\mathcal{A}v_f) = P_0\mathcal{A}_0 \delta v_f. \quad (25)$$

Terms $\delta P\mathcal{A}_0 v_{f,0}$ and $P_0\delta\mathcal{A}v_{f,0}$ vanish. Eddy-viscosity heating and the mechanical power vU_q are also second order, although δU_q remains in momentum.

The LNA uses continuous time derivatives. It does not differentiate a finite timestep or retain the nonlinear velocity/pressure time weights. The choice of local versus flux work still applies; turning on nonlinear velocity time centering does not select the local work form.

At the physical inner boundary $k = N$, the fixed inward velocity has zero perturbation, so the inward term in $\delta \mathcal{W}_N$ is absent. A temperature-selected envelope cut instead retains the full-model stencil and discards excluded variable columns. It does not introduce a new physical boundary or replace its pressure coefficients.

RSP2 eps_grav: entropy and turbulent storage. This is an alternative energy row for RSP2 with either velocity grid. Define the separate non-EOS work by

$$\mathcal{W}_{\neg\text{EOS},k} = \frac{P_{c,k} - P_{\text{eos},k}}{\Delta m_k} \dot{V}_k. \quad (26)$$

The EOS compression is already contained in ϵ_{grav} .

Model equation.

$$\dot{E}_{t,k} = -D_m L_k + \epsilon_k + \epsilon_{\text{grav},k} - \mathcal{W}_{\neg\text{EOS},k}. \quad (27)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\begin{aligned} -D_m \delta L_k + \delta \epsilon_k - \delta \mathcal{W}_{\neg\text{EOS},k} = \sigma \bigg\{ & 2w_k \delta w_k \\ & + T_k C_{P,k} \left[(1 - \nabla_{\text{ad},k} \chi_{T,k}) \delta \ln T_k - \nabla_{\text{ad},k} \chi_{\rho,k} \delta \ln \rho_k \right] \bigg\}. \end{aligned} \quad (28)$$

This display uses the standard thermal coefficients with `eps_grav_factor = 1`; Appendix A.5 gives the implemented latent-heat and entropy-blend substitutions. The non-EOS work linearization uses the background $P_c - P_{\text{eos}}$ times the perturbed volume rate. *Code:* `energy_inertia_for_star_LNA` and `dwork_dm_for_star_LNA`. The work control does not select a face-work or mechanical-inertia branch for this energy option.

Relation to local-work dedt. For a consistent EOS at fixed composition, write $\nu = 1/\rho$. Then

$$\epsilon_{\text{grav}} = -\dot{e} - P_{\text{eos}} \dot{\nu}, \quad (29)$$

$$\delta \epsilon_{\text{grav}} = -\sigma \left(\delta e - \frac{P_{\text{eos}}}{\rho} \delta \ln \rho \right). \quad (30)$$

Using mass conservation in the local-work `dedt` row gives this same continuous thermodynamic relation, plus the turbulent terms. ϵ_{grav} is not simply $-\dot{\Phi}$. Adding explicit EOS pressure work or $\dot{e}$ to the `eps_grav` row would count those terms twice. Numerical EOS derivatives and finite-step time discretizations can differ, so this relation does not guarantee identical numerical modes or nonlinear timesteps. The two formulations remain separately documented.

2.5 Transport: one row in the luminosity slot

Routine `assemble_luminosity_rows` selects exactly one of the following interior rows. The surface replacement is in Section 2.9. The matrix unknown in this slot is δL , even when the equation is written as a temperature gradient. The nonlinear solver retains the existing name `equL` for this transport row. RSP2's additional flux row is `rsp2_flux`, with index `i_rsp2_flux`; row labels do not assign one equation to one unknown.

Perturbed TDC or frozen convective flux. The face closure supplies L_r and L_c .

Model equation.

$$L_{r,k} + L_{c,k} - L_k = 0. \quad (31)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\delta L_{r,k} + \delta L_{c,k} - \delta L_k = 0. \quad (32)$$

For `frozen_flux`, replace L_c by its fixed background value $L_{c,0}$ and set $\delta L_c = 0$ in this same row. *Code:* `tdc_luminosity_resid_for_star_LNA` or `frozen_flux_luminosity_resid_for_star_LNA`. The TDC coefficients are given in Appendix B.

Static MLT or RSP2: logarithmic-pressure form. Here $P = P_{\text{eos}}$. Define $\Delta \ln P_k = \ln P_{k-1} - \ln P_k$ and similarly for T . This branch has priority when `use_gradT_actual_vs_gradT_MLT_for_T_gradient_eqn` is true.

Model equation.

$$\nabla_k \Delta \ln P_k - \Delta \ln T_k = 0. \quad (33)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\Delta \ln P_k \delta \nabla_k + \nabla_k \delta \Delta \ln P_k - \delta \Delta \ln T_k = 0. \quad (34)$$

Code: `temperature_gradient_resid_for_star_LNA`. The EOS supplies $\delta \ln P = \chi_\rho \delta \ln \rho + \chi_T \delta \ln T$. For RSP2, $\nabla = \nabla_{L,\text{eff}} + Y_{\text{face}}$ and $\delta \nabla = \delta \nabla_{L,\text{eff}} + \delta Y_{\text{face}}$. The independent flux row in Section 2.7 supplies $L_r + L_c + L_t = L$; no local inversion for Y_{face} remains.

Static MLT or RSP2: radiation-pressure form. If the preceding branch is off and `use_dPrad_dm_form_of_T_gradient_eqn` is true, define

$$K_f = \frac{\Delta m_f \kappa_f}{c \mathcal{A}_f^2 \lambda_f}, \quad \Delta P_{\text{rad},k} = \frac{a}{3} (T_{k-1}^4 - T_k^4). \quad (35)$$

Model equation.

$$-K_f L_{r,k} - \Delta P_{\text{rad},k} = 0. \quad (36)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$-K_f \delta L_{r,k} - L_{r,k} \delta K_f - \frac{4a}{3} (T_{k-1}^4 \delta \ln T_{k-1} - T_k^4 \delta \ln T_k) = 0. \quad (37)$$

Code: `dPrad_dm_resid_for_star_LNA`. At fixed mass, $\delta K_f / K_f = \delta \kappa_f / \kappa_f - 4 \delta \ln r_f - \delta \lambda_f / \lambda_f$. Appendix A.8 specifies the opacity floor, radiative flux limiter, radiative luminosity, and inner-boundary spacing.

Static MLT or RSP2: QHSE form. When both preceding switches are off, define

$$h_f = (d \ln P / dm)_{\text{QHSE}}, \quad \Delta m_{c,f} = \frac{\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k}{2}, \quad (38)$$

with the mass-weighted temperature

$$T_{*,f} = a_f T_k + (1 - a_f) T_{k-1}, \quad a_f = \frac{\Delta m_{k-1}}{\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k}. \quad (39)$$

Model equation.

$$\Delta m_{c,f} h_f \nabla_k - \frac{T_{k-1} - T_k}{T_{*,f}} = 0. \quad (40)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = \Delta m_{c,f} (h_f \delta \nabla_k + \nabla_k \delta h_f) - \frac{\delta T_{k-1} - \delta T_k}{T_{*,f}} \\ + \frac{T_{k-1} - T_k}{T_{*,f}^2} \delta T_{*,f}. \end{aligned} \quad (41)$$

Code: `temperature_gradient_resid_for_star_LNA` and `star_LNA_eval_dlnPdm_qhse`. Here $\delta T = T \delta \ln T$ and $\delta T_{*,f} = a_f \delta T_k + (1 - a_f) \delta T_{k-1}$. For active TDC, the selected spatial relation instead supplies the gradient inside its closure; the global row remains equation (32).

2.6 Additional row for perturbed TDC

The internal convection amplitude is $A = v_c/\sqrt{2/3}$ at the face. Let $F_A = S_0 - AD_{R0} - A^2D_0$, with the buoyancy and damping coefficients specified in Appendix B. The compressive term uses face density.

Model equation.

$$2\dot{A} - \frac{2}{3}\alpha_{Pt}A\ln\rho_f = S_0 - AD_{R0} - A^2D_0. \quad (42)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\delta S_0 - (D_{R0} + 2AD_0)\delta A - A\delta D_{R0} - A^2\delta D_0 = \sigma \left(2\delta A - \frac{2}{3}\alpha_{Pt}A\delta\ln\rho_f \right). \quad (43)$$

Code: `assemble_tdc_w_row`, `tdc_relation_for_star_LNA`, and `set_TDC_LNA`. The AD inertia is represented locally by

$$I_A = 2A + \frac{2}{3}\alpha_{Pt}A_0\frac{\rho_{f,0}}{\rho_f}, \quad \delta I_A = 2\delta A - \frac{2}{3}\alpha_{Pt}A_0\delta\ln\rho_f. \quad (44)$$

Only the variation of this expression is used; A_0 and $\rho_{f,0}$ are held fixed. Nonconvective or forced-zero faces use the algebraic constraint in Section 2.9. Static MLT and frozen-flux treatments do not add this convection unknown.

2.7 Additional rows for RSP2

Turbulent energy. Use $e_t = w^2$, $C = S - D - D_r$, turbulent luminosity L_t , and turbulent pressure P_t . The source and flux formulas are in Appendix C.

Model equation.

$$\frac{dw_k^2}{dt} = C_k + Eq_k - \frac{L_{t,k} - L_{t,k+1}}{\Delta m_k} - \frac{P_{t,k}}{\Delta m_k}\dot{V}_k. \quad (45)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\delta C_k - \frac{\delta L_{t,k} - \delta L_{t,k+1}}{\Delta m_k} - \frac{P_{t,k}}{\Delta m_k}\delta\dot{V}_k = \sigma 2w_k\delta w_k. \quad (46)$$

Code: `assemble_rsp2_w_row` and `rsp2_turbulent_energy_rhs_for_star_LNA`. Here $\delta C = \delta S - \delta D - \delta D_r$ and $\delta\dot{V}_k = \mathcal{A}_k\delta v_{f,k} - \mathcal{A}_{k+1}\delta v_{f,k+1}$, with fixed physical inner velocity. The compression coefficient is the background P_t , because $\dot{V}_0 = 0$. Viscous heating is quadratic about a static background, so $\delta Eq = 0$. Forced nonturbulent cells use $\delta w = 0$. In the three equation model, $C = S - D$: radiative cooling acts in the entropy moments, so the direct D_r term is absent. Both gas energy forms retain their existing turbulent storage term; no additional exchange term is added.

Independent face superadiabaticity and flux balance. The new face unknown is signed $Y_{\text{face},k}$, stored in `i_Y`. The gradient and its variation are

$$\nabla_k = \nabla_{L,\text{eff},k} + Y_{\text{face},k}, \quad \delta \nabla_k = \delta \nabla_{L,\text{eff},k} + \delta Y_{\text{face},k}. \quad (47)$$

Model equation.

$$\begin{cases} L_{r,k} + L_{c,k} + L_{t,k} - L_k = 0, & k > 1, \\ Y_{\text{face},1} = 0, & k = 1. \end{cases} \quad (48)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\begin{cases} \delta L_{r,k} + \delta L_{c,k} + \delta L_{t,k} - \delta L_k = 0, & k > 1, \\ \delta Y_{\text{face},1} = 0, & k = 1. \end{cases} \quad (49)$$

Code: `assemble_rsp2_flux_row` and `hydro_rsp2:rsp2_flux_residual`. The nonlinear interior row is

$$R_{\text{flux},k} = \frac{L_{r,k} + L_{c,k} + L_{t,k} - L_k}{\max(|L_{\text{start},k}|, 10^{-3} \max_j |L_{\text{start},j}|, 1 \text{ erg s}^{-1})}. \quad (50)$$

This follows the TDC luminosity scale, adding a finite floor and using absolute values in the global maximum. Before solver iterations, current `L` initializes the scale. During iterations it uses `L_start`, so its derivatives are zero. LNA uses the same residual and holds its background normalization fixed. The surface constraint $Y_1 = 0$ is dimensionless. The Newton correction measure uses $|\Delta Y| / \max(1, |Y_{\text{start}}|)$: the native dimensionless column scale with unit correction weight. This gives an absolute scale near zero and a relative scale at large magnitude. Y is included in the norm and remains signed. The physical surface luminosity/temperature condition remains in its separate row. Radiative cells retain the flux equation and may have negative Y .

2.8 Optional RSP2 entropy moment rows

These two face rows are present only in the three equation model. The cell variable remains w , and the face turbulent energy is $e_{t,f} = a_f w_k^2 + (1 - a_f) w_{k-1}^2$. The face entropy flux is $\text{Pi}_f = \langle v'_r s' \rangle$, and $\text{Phi}_f = \langle s'^2 \rangle$ is the full entropy variance. The entropy differential and face coefficients are specified in Appendix D.5.

Entropy flux. Pi carries its own time dependence.

Model equation.

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{\text{Pi}}_f = & \frac{2}{3} e_{t,f} (-\partial_r s)_f + \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \text{Phi}_f \\ & - \left(\alpha_{\text{Pi}} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} + (\partial_r v_{\text{rad}})_f \right) \text{Pi}_f. \end{aligned} \quad (51)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma \delta \text{Pi}_f = & \frac{2}{3} [(-\partial_r s)_f \delta e_{t,f} + e_{t,f} \delta (-\partial_r s)_f] \\ & + \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \delta \text{Phi}_f \\ & + \text{Phi}_f \delta \left[-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \frac{\chi_T}{\chi_{\rho} C_P} \right]_f \\ & - \left(\alpha_{\text{Pi}} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \delta \text{Pi}_f \\ & - \text{Pi}_f \delta \left[\alpha_{\text{Pi}} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} + (\partial_r v_{\text{rad}})_f \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (52)$$

The linearized expression assumes a static background. Mean strain vanishes there, but its velocity perturbation is retained.

Entropy variance. Phi is the full variance of specific entropy.

Model equation.

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{\text{Phi}}_f = & 2(-\partial_r s)_f \text{Pi}_f \\ & - \left(\alpha_{\text{Phi}} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \text{Phi}_f. \end{aligned} \quad (53)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma \delta \text{Phi}_f = & 2(-\partial_r s)_f \delta \text{Pi}_f + 2\text{Pi}_f \delta (-\partial_r s)_f \\ & - \left(\alpha_{\text{Phi}} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \delta \text{Phi}_f \\ & - \text{Phi}_f \delta \left[\alpha_{\text{Phi}} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (54)$$

Code: `hydro_rsp2:rsp2_moment_rhs`, `do1_rsp2_moment_eqns`, and `assemble_rsp2_moment_rows`. Both moments use backward Euler in nonlinear hydro and identity inertia in LNA. The continuous LNA coefficients omit finite timestep centering. There is no spatial transport or additional viscosity in these two rows. The existing L_t and Eq/Uq terms remain in the energy and momentum equations.

Forced faces use $\text{Pi} = \text{Phi} = 0$. Fully dormant faces with both adjacent turbulent energies and both moments zero use the same zero branch. A face beside finite turbulent energy retains both evolution rows. LNA fixes $\delta w = 0$ in a fully dormant cell. At zero represented cell energy, including underflow of w^2 , a local row without a source seed or kinetic transport also uses this constraint when $S_k/w_k \leq 0$. The factored source ratio determines the branch on the current static background; accepted timestep history does not enter LNA. Positive driving or nonlocal coupling retains the physical energy row. Constraining a cell does not constrain its active bounding moment faces. Active moments at exactly zero face energy have no regular linearization in these variables and cause an explicit LNA error. The dormant branch does not describe spontaneous turbulence onset.

Derived scale heights and mixing lengths. RSP2 uses TDC's public face helpers, `get_TDC_Hp_face` and `get_TDC_mixing_length_face`. Both models obtain cell lengths from `get_TDC_mixing_length_cell`. Face lengths retain the ordinary or reconstructed face state. The cell length uses its own EOS pressure and density, with gravity averaged over its bounding faces:

$$g_{\text{cell},k} = \frac{1}{2}(g_k + g_{k+1}), \quad g_j = \frac{G_j m_{\text{grav},j}}{r_j^2}, \quad (55)$$

$$H_{P,\text{cell},k}^{\text{HSE}} = \frac{P_{\text{eos},k}}{\rho_k g_{\text{cell},k}}, \quad r_{\text{cell},k} = \left[\frac{1}{2}(r_k^3 + r_{k+1}^3) \right]^{1/3}. \quad (56)$$

At a full centre, $g_{N+1} = 0$; an excised boundary uses $g_{N+1} = G_N M_{\text{centre}}/R_{\text{centre}}^2$. For $\beta_h = \text{harmonic_dissipation_length_beta} \leq 0$, the alternate-height option replaces H_P^{HSE} by $\min(H_P^{\text{HSE}}, \sqrt{P_{\text{eos}}/G_k}/\rho)$ in that cell. For $\beta_h > 0$, the HSE height is used directly. Writing the selected height as $H_{P,\text{cell}}$, the shared length law gives

$$\Lambda_{\text{cell},k} = \begin{cases} \alpha_{\text{MLT}} H_{P,\text{cell},k}, & \beta_h \leq 0, \\ [(\alpha_{\text{MLT}} H_{P,\text{cell},k})^{-1} + (\beta_h r_{\text{cell},k})^{-1}]^{-1}, & \beta_h > 0. \end{cases} \quad (57)$$

The EOS state is not interpolated through faces a second time. These lengths are differentiated functions of the cell state and bounding radii; there is no H_P row or independent δH_P . RSP2 cell w and TDC face convective velocity retain their separate storage and viscosity averaging.

2.9 Surface rows and fixed perturbations

Surface momentum or pressure. `assemble_surface_velocity_row` replaces the interior momentum row at $k = 1$. A fixed surface velocity has first priority and imposes $\delta v_{\text{rad},1} = 0$, as in Section 2.9. Otherwise, any of `use_momentum_outer_BC`, `use_zero_Pgas_outer_BC`, or `use_fixed_Psurf_outer_BC` selects the dynamic surface equation.

Model equation.

$$\dot{v}_{\text{rad},1} = F_{\text{surf},1}(P_{\text{bc}}, \dots). \quad (58)$$

Linearized dynamic row.

$$\delta F_{\text{surf},1} = \sigma \delta v_{\text{rad},1}. \quad (59)$$

Code: `surface_momentum_rhs_for_star_LNA`. The force is the selected momentum formula above, with outer pressure P_{bc} ; on the face grid, $\Delta P_{\text{tot},1} = P_{\text{bc}} - P_{\text{tot},1}$.

Without a surface momentum condition, the replacement is algebraic:

Model equation.

$$\ln P_{\text{bc}} - \ln P_{\text{eos},1} = 0. \quad (60)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\delta \ln P_{\text{bc}} - \chi_{\rho,1} \delta \ln \rho_1 - \chi_{T,1} \delta \ln T_1 = 0. \quad (61)$$

Code: `surface_P_bc_for_star_LNA` supplies either a fixed pressure or the atmosphere pressure and its supported AD response.

Surface luminosity or temperature. The surface transport slot also contains one row. For RSP2, `RSP2_use_L_eqn_at_surface` selects its own luminosity boundary first. Otherwise `use_RSP_L_eqn_outer_BC` selects the shared boundary, also used with TDC. Both give the following continuous luminosity condition:

Model equation.

$$L_1 = L_{\text{surf}}, \quad L_{\text{surf}} = f_{L,\text{surf}} 4\pi r_1^2 c a T_1^4. \quad (62)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\delta L_1 - L_{\text{surf}}(2\delta \ln r_1 + 4\delta \ln T_1) = 0. \quad (63)$$

Code: `rsp_lsrf_resid_for_star_LNA`, with $f_{L,\text{surf}} = \text{RSP2_Lsurf_factor}$.

Otherwise the atmosphere temperature supplies the row:

Model equation.

$$\ln T_{\text{bc}} - \ln T_1 = 0. \quad (64)$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\delta \ln T_{\text{bc}} - \delta \ln T_1 = 0. \quad (65)$$

Code: `surface_temperature_resid_for_star_LNA` and `surface_lnT_bc_for_star_LNA`. The atmospheric face-to-center offset and its variation are given in Appendix H.

Forced-zero rows. These replace the radius row in a zero-velocity cell, the momentum row for a fixed surface velocity, or the TDC/RSP2 convection row where the amplitude is forced to zero. Here z is that constrained variable.

Model equation.

$$z = z_{\text{fixed}}. \tag{66}$$

Linearized algebraic row.

$$\delta z = 0. \tag{67}$$

Code: `assemble_radius_rows`, `assemble_surface_velocity_row`, `assemble_tdc_w_row`, and `assemble_rsp2_w_row`. At the envelope cut, excluded perturbations are zero by omission of their columns, not by adding further constraint rows.

3 From the linearized rows to the eigensolve

Routine `setup_star_LNA_problem` constructs a `star_LNA_problem` containing the variable map, equation identifier for every row, and dense matrices. The top level sequence in `do_star_LNA` is

1. refresh the MESA variables with `set_vars_if_needed`;
2. reject unsupported model branches in `check_star_LNA_model`;
3. rebuild the Riemann face state for `u_flag`; RSP2 viscosity is a cell momentum source, not a contact-velocity shift;
4. construct the problem and report the selected variables;
5. assemble density, radius, momentum, energy, luminosity, RSP2, and TDC rows in that order;
6. write matrix and closure audits when requested;
7. solve and write mode products; and
8. release the problem through `free_star_LNA_problem`.

The colored rows above assemble the single problem

$$\mathbf{A}\hat{\mathbf{x}} = \sigma\mathbf{B}\hat{\mathbf{x}}. \quad (68)$$

For $\dot{q} = F(q)$, the perturbation δF enters $\mathbf{A}$ and δq enters $\mathbf{B}$. Algebraic equations enter only $\mathbf{A}$. Automatic differentiation components are mapped to neighboring zone variables by `add_ad_partials_to_matrix`.

The equation registry distinguishes density, radius, forced zero velocity, interior and surface momentum variants, energy, each luminosity closure, RSP2 turbulent energy and face flux, and active or forced zero TDC velocity rows. It is mechanical metadata: row formulas remain in their direct row assemblers.

3.1 Algebraic elimination and eigenpair refinement

Routine `scale_star_LNA_matrix_for_solver` scales each row and then each column by its largest absolute entry across $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$. A nominally dynamic variable remains in the generalized problem only when its row contains a time derivative. Thus a forced $\delta w_k = 0$ row is algebraic, while a TDC turbulent-velocity row remains dynamic. Let x_a denote algebraic variables and x_d dynamic variables. Since algebraic rows have no $\mathbf{B}$ entries,

$$A_{aa}x_a + A_{ad}x_d = 0, \quad x_a = -A_{aa}^{-1}A_{ad}x_d. \quad (69)$$

Substitution gives

$$(A_{dd} - A_{da}A_{aa}^{-1}A_{ad})x_d = \sigma(B_{dd} - B_{da}A_{aa}^{-1}A_{ad})x_d. \quad (70)$$

`build_reduced_star_LNA_problem` uses equilibrated `DGESVX` with iterative refinement to evaluate $A_{aa}^{-1}A_{ad}$. Elimination changes the row and column norms. Routine `scale_star_LNA_pencil` therefore applies alternating row and column max-norm scaling to the reduced matrices. With t_{dyn} equal to the model dynamical timescale, the scaled problem is

$$\tilde{A}y = \lambda\tilde{B}y, \quad \tilde{A} = RA_{\text{red}}C, \quad \tilde{B} = \frac{RB_{\text{red}}C}{t_{\text{dyn}}}, \quad \lambda = \sigma t_{\text{dyn}}. \quad (71)$$

This keeps radial-mode eigenvalues near unity during `DGGEV`. The code restores $x_d = Cy$, reconstructs x_a , and then reverses the full-pencil column scaling.

Each candidate is checked against the original full matrices using the componentwise backward error

$$\epsilon_{\text{eig}} = \max_i \frac{|(Ax - \sigma Bx)_i|}{\sum_j |A_{ij}x_j| + |\sigma| \sum_j |B_{ij}x_j|}. \quad (72)$$

Let $\epsilon_{\text{max}} = \text{star_LNA_max_eigenvector_residual}$, which must be positive and defaults to 10^{-3} . The triangle inequality bounds ϵ_{eig} by one; evaluation enforces this upper bound after checking for nonfinite values. A limit of one therefore provides no eigenvector accuracy requirement. A candidate above $\min(\epsilon_{\text{max}}, 10^{-1})$ enters `refine_star_LNA_eigenpair`. The Newton update can change frequency when either $\epsilon_{\text{eig}} \leq 10^{-1}$ or its balanced normwise residual satisfies

$$\epsilon_{\text{norm}} = \frac{\max_i |(A_s x_s - \sigma B_s x_s)_i|}{\max_i \left(\sum_j |(A_s)_{ij}(x_s)_j| + |\sigma| \sum_j |(B_s)_{ij}(x_s)_j| \right)} \leq 10^{-6}. \quad (73)$$

Here A_s, B_s, x_s use the full matrix scaling before algebraic elimination. Tiny moment components can have order-unity relative errors even when the eigenpair has a small normwise defect. This second criterion allows those components to be refined; it does not replace the final componentwise test. On the scaled full matrices, define $M = A - \sigma B$ and $r = Mx$. The Newton correction satisfies

$$M \delta x - Bx \delta \sigma = -r, \quad \delta x_j = 0, \quad (74)$$

where j is the largest component of the current eigenvector at each iteration. Two solves give

$$y = M^{-1}(-r), \quad z = M^{-1}Bx, \quad \delta \sigma = -y_j/z_j, \quad \delta x = y + z \delta \sigma. \quad (75)$$

If neither initial criterion holds, keep σ fixed and replace x by z/z_j . This inverse iteration repairs the eigenvector before allowing a frequency correction. Its trial update is a weighted average of the old and repaired vectors, preserving tiny components without subtractive loss. Each iteration uses `ZGBTRF` and `ZGBTRS` on the full banded matrix. At most four refinement steps are accepted; backtracking requires a decrease in the scaled residual. The refined pair is retained only if it also reduces the residual against the original unscaled matrices. The residual limit and mode filters are then applied.

The solve computes the full reduced eigensystem. The requested mode count limits output, not eigensolve cost.

The scaling passes require quadratic work in the matrix dimension. Candidate residuals use the matrix bandwidth, as does the local Newton correction. Dense algebraic elimination and `DGGEV` require cubic work and determine the large-model scaling. A targeted sparse or iterative solver is therefore required to make the requested mode count reduce the main solve cost.

A Pressure, energy, and face closures

These quantities supply coefficients and derivatives to the rows in Section 2. They are not additional global equations.

A.1 Pressure

The cell pressure closure shared by the operator and pressure work output is

$$P_{\text{tot}} = P_{\text{eos}} + P_{\text{t,RSP2}}, \quad P_{\text{t,RSP2}} = \alpha_p \frac{2}{3} \rho e_t, \quad e_t = w^2, \quad (\text{A.1})$$

when RSP2 turbulent pressure perturbations are enabled. TDC/MLT turbulent pressure remains face centered and enters separately through `d_mlt_Pturb_face_for_star_LNA`:

$$P_{\text{t,MLT},f} = f_{\text{Pt}} \frac{\rho_f v_c^2}{3}. \quad (\text{A.2})$$

The separate MLT pressure term in face momentum uses one convection velocity coefficient multiplying a cell-density difference:

$$\Delta P_{\text{MLT},k} = \frac{f_{\text{Pt}}}{3} v_{c,k}^2 (\rho_{k-1} - \rho_k), \quad (\text{A.3})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \delta \Delta P_{\text{MLT},k} = \frac{f_{\text{Pt}}}{3} [v_{c,k}^2 (\rho_{k-1} \delta \ln \rho_{k-1} - \rho_k \delta \ln \rho_k) \\ + 2v_{c,k} (\rho_{k-1} - \rho_k) \delta v_{c,k}]. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.4})$$

These expressions apply when turbulent-pressure perturbations are enabled. Active TDC supplies δv_c from its internal amplitude. Otherwise the helper uses a positive `mlt_vc_old` as a fixed coefficient, so $\delta v_c = 0$ in this term. The term is zero when its controls or velocity condition are inactive. It is not a difference of independently evaluated turbulent pressures at two adjacent faces.

A.2 Work coefficients on the two grids

Section 2.4 gives both work stencils and their linearizations. Their pressure coefficients are constructed differently. For local work, `dwork_dm_for_star_LNA` uses

$$P_{c,k,0} = P_{\text{tot},k,0} + f_{\text{Pt}} \frac{\rho_{f,k,0} v_{c,\text{old},k}^2}{3}, \quad (\text{A.5})$$

where the second term is included only for $k > 1$, `mlt_Pturb_factor` > 0 , and `mlt_vc_old(k)` > 0 . This face-density contribution to the cell work coefficient is evaluated by `get_rho_face`; it is not replaced by the Riemann pressure.

For flux work on the face-velocity grid, `static_face_pressure_for_star_LNA` gives

$$P_{f,k,0} = a_k P_{\text{tot},k,0} + (1 - a_k) P_{\text{tot},k-1,0} + P_{\text{t,MLT},f,k,0}, \quad a_k = \frac{\Delta m_{k-1}}{\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k}. \quad (\text{A.6})$$

At $k = 1$, the cell-pressure part is $P_{\text{tot},1,0}$. The MLT addition uses current v_c and the TDC face state for an active TDC face with positive velocity; otherwise it uses the positive `mlt_vc_old` and `get_rho_face_val` when enabled. For flux work with `u_flag`, the code instead takes the values of `s%P_face_ad`, including the surface convention stated in the main text. These distinctions must be retained when comparing energy and momentum pressure terms.

A.3 Mechanical energy inertia

For the supported case without mass corrections, `star_utils:cell_specific_KE_qp` uses

$$K_k = \begin{cases} u_k^2/2, & \text{u_flag,} \\ (v_k^2 + v_{k+1}^2)/4, & \text{v_flag,} \\ 0, & \text{neither hydro velocity flag.} \end{cases} \quad (\text{A.7})$$

Consequently,

$$\delta K_k = \begin{cases} u_{k,0}\delta u_k, & \text{u_flag,} \\ (v_{k,0}\delta v_k + v_{k+1,0}\delta v_{k+1})/2, & \text{v_flag,} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (\text{A.8})$$

Both hydrodynamic expressions vanish on a static background. The face scheme averages the squares of the bounding velocities; it does not square their average. At N , the inward velocity is fixed.

For $k < N$, `cell_specific_PE_qp` gives the same gravitational energy for both velocity grids:

$$\Phi_k = -\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{G_k m_{g,k}}{r_k} + \frac{G_{k+1} m_{g,k+1}}{r_{k+1}} \right), \quad (\text{A.9})$$

$$\delta \Phi_k = \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{G_k m_{g,k}}{r_k} \delta \ln r_k + \frac{G_{k+1} m_{g,k+1}}{r_{k+1}} \delta \ln r_{k+1} \right). \quad (\text{A.10})$$

This is the average of the two face potentials, not a cell-center $-Gm/r$ approximation. At N , a nonzero fixed `R_center` contributes a constant inward potential; its perturbation is zero. The contribution is omitted when `R_center` = 0. An envelope cut drops excluded perturbation columns and keeps the background coefficients.

`mechanical_energy_inertia_for_star_LNA` calls `get_dke_dt_dpe_dt` with a unit time interval to recover these derivatives. It places them in `B` only when `energy_eqn_option` = 'dedt' and the local-work control is false. A retained kinetic derivative at a small nonzero background velocity does not make the rest of the operator a nonstatic linearization.

A.4 Turbulent energy and the RSP2 gas-energy relation

The control `star_LNA_perturb_turbulent_energy` gates the cell turbulent inertia. When it is false, `turbulent_energy_inertia_for_star_LNA` returns zero. Otherwise RSP2 contributes

$$E_{t,k} = w_k^2, \quad \delta E_{t,k} = 2w_k \delta w_k. \quad (\text{A.11})$$

For TDC, inclusion additionally requires `star_LNA_include_tdc`, `MLT_option` = 'TDC', and `TDC_include_eturb_in_energy_equation`. The cell inertia is

$$E_{t,k} = \frac{3}{4}(v_{c,k}^2 + v_{c,k+1}^2) = \frac{1}{2}(A_k^2 + A_{k+1}^2), \quad (\text{A.12})$$

$$\delta E_{t,k} = A_k \delta A_k + A_{k+1} \delta A_{k+1}, \quad k < N. \quad (\text{A.13})$$

Only the first face term remains at the physical inner cell N . Active TDC uses its internal LNA amplitude through `turbulent_tdc_energy_inertia_for_star_LNA`. The nonactive TDC branch, when these inclusion controls still apply, takes derivatives from `s%mlt_vc_ad`; it does not introduce a new amplitude unknown. These are cell energy coefficients, distinct from the TDC face-amplitude inertia I_A in equation (44).

For the local-work RSP2 case with turbulent energy and pressure included, and without an additional MLT pressure term, the two equations are

$$\dot{e} + \dot{E}_t = -D_m(L_r + L_c + L_t) + \epsilon + Eq - (P_{\text{eos}} + P_t)\dot{V}/\Delta m, \quad (\text{A.14})$$

$$\dot{E}_t = C + Eq - D_m L_t - P_t \dot{V}/\Delta m. \quad (\text{A.15})$$

Subtracting the second from the first gives

$$\dot{e} = -D_m(L_r + L_c) + \epsilon - C - P_{\text{eos}}\dot{V}/\Delta m, \quad (\text{A.16})$$

$$\sigma \delta e = -D_m(\delta L_r + \delta L_c) + \delta \epsilon - \delta C - \frac{P_{\text{eos},0}}{\Delta m} \delta \dot{V}. \quad (\text{A.17})$$

Thus L_t , Eq , and turbulent-pressure work cancel in the derived gas row; none is counted twice. This gas-energy equation is a derived combination of assembled rows, not an extra row. In the flux-work branch the mechanical terms and face-pressure stencil must also be retained in the subtraction. Freezing the turbulent inertia or pressure removes the corresponding cancellation.

A.5 The `eps_grav` coefficients and their limits

For a thermodynamically consistent EOS at fixed composition, the thermal part of the first-law relation can also be written

$$\epsilon_{\text{grav}} = -TC_P \left[(1 - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_T) \ln T - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_\rho \ln \rho \right]. \quad (\text{A.18})$$

The standard MESA implementation is `eps_grav:do_std_eps_grav`. Its static thermal variation is

$$\delta \epsilon_{\text{grav}} = -\sigma TC_P [(1 - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_T) \delta \ln T - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_\rho \delta \ln \rho]. \quad (\text{A.19})$$

The identity linking this to the internal-energy derivatives is

$$\delta e - \frac{P_{\text{eos}}}{\rho} \delta \ln \rho = TC_P [(1 - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_T) \delta \ln T - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_\rho \delta \ln \rho]. \quad (\text{A.20})$$

This is a thermodynamic comparison. Numerical EOS quantities, especially across blends, need not satisfy the identity exactly. Finite-step `dedt` and `eps_grav` residuals also have different time discretizations. Equality of these continuous expressions therefore does not establish identical numerical operators or finite-step solutions.

For RSP2, `energy_inertia_for_star_LNA` implements the two thermal coefficients directly. Its standard branch adds the stored latent-heat terms:

$$B_{\ln \rho} = -TC_P \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_\rho + \text{latent_ddlnRho}, \quad (\text{A.21})$$

$$B_{\ln T} = TC_P (1 - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_T) + \text{latent_ddlnT}. \quad (\text{A.22})$$

In the PC EOS entropy transition it uses the same background Gamma thresholds as `eval1_eps_grav_and_partials`, blending this standard expression with $T_0 \delta s$. The thermal contribution is multiplied by `eps_grav_factor`; $2w\delta w$ is then added without that factor. The blend weight is a background coefficient: its perturbation multiplies a zero background time derivative. Composition perturbations vanish in the fixed-composition LNA. The nonlinear time-centering weights are not part of the continuous LNA operator. User `other_eps_grav` hooks are rejected.

The corresponding nonlinear RSP2 path calls the existing `eval_eps_grav_and_partials`, retaining its composition and finite-step choices. See `star/private/eps_grav.f90` and `star/defaults/controls.defaults`. Non-RSP2 LNA retains its `dedt`-only restriction.

A.6 Source derivatives

`energy_sources_for_star_LNA` retains the stored nuclear derivatives with respect to $\ln \rho$ and $\ln T$. Nuclear heating is fixed when the selected split-burn branch uses `burn_avg_eps_nuc`, and the explicit nuclear term is zero for zero `eps_nuc_factor` or the nonlocal Ni/Co decay branch. The nonnuclear neutrino coefficient retains the nonlinear half weight:

$$\delta\epsilon_{\nu,\text{nonnuc}} = \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{\partial\epsilon_{\nu,\text{nonnuc}}}{\partial \ln \rho} \delta \ln \rho + \frac{\partial\epsilon_{\nu,\text{nonnuc}}}{\partial \ln T} \delta \ln T \right]. \quad (\text{A.23})$$

It enters $\delta\epsilon$ with a minus sign. `extra_heat` and `irradiation_heat` are fixed coefficients. The diffusion, sedimentation, premixing, and phase-separation `others` terms of the nonlinear energy equation supply no additional LNA derivatives. Static viscous heating and vU_q have zero first-order variation, as described in Appendix D.

A.7 Riemann face state for `u_flag`

Routine `hydro_riemann:do1_uface_and_Pface` uses the inner cell $L = k$ and outer cell $R = k - 1$. Let $\tilde{P}_L, \tilde{P}_R$ be their cell pressures after the gravity reconstruction, with

$$h_g = -\frac{G_k m_{g,k}}{r_k^2 \mathcal{A}_k}, \quad (\text{A.24})$$

$$\tilde{P}_L = P_L + \frac{\Delta m_k}{2} h_g, \quad \tilde{P}_R = P_R - \frac{\Delta m_{k-1}}{2} h_g. \quad (\text{A.25})$$

The acoustic speeds use the unreconstructed cell pressures: $c_{s,L}^2 = \Gamma_{1,L} P_L / \rho_L$ and similarly for R . The selected wave speeds and contact state are

$$S_L = \min(u_L - c_{s,L}, u_R - c_{s,R}), \quad (\text{A.26})$$

$$S_R = \max(u_R + c_{s,R}, u_L + c_{s,L}), \quad (\text{A.27})$$

$$Z = \rho_R(S_R - u_R) + \rho_L(u_L - S_L), \quad (\text{A.28})$$

$$v_f = S_* = \frac{\rho_R u_R (S_R - u_R) + \rho_L u_L (u_L - S_L) + \tilde{P}_L - \tilde{P}_R}{Z}, \quad (\text{A.29})$$

$$P_f = \frac{1}{2} \left[\tilde{P}_L + \rho_L (u_L - S_L)(u_L - S_*) + \tilde{P}_R + \rho_R (u_R - S_R)(u_R - S_*) \right]. \quad (\text{A.30})$$

Writing the numerator of S_* as N_* ,

$$\delta v_f = \frac{\delta N_* - v_{f,0} \delta Z}{Z_0}. \quad (\text{A.31})$$

AD differentiates the selected wave-speed branches, the EOS response, and the gravity reconstruction. At $v_{f,0} = 0$, this reduces to $\delta N_*/Z_0$, which still contains the pressure-difference response. The same contact velocity enters the radius equation and both work forms. P_f is differentiated in momentum; in static work only its background value multiplies δv_f .

At $k = 1$, the routine sets $v_f = u_1$ and $P_f = P_{\text{eos},1}$ directly. The outward momentum flux separately uses P_{bc} . `do_star_LNA` rebuilds this face state. RSP2 now puts its viscous force in cell momentum, using `compute_Uq_dm_cell`; it does not add an acceleration to the contact velocity. The static counterpart is `Uq_cell_for_star_LNA`. Active turbulent pressure with `u_flag` still requires `star_LNA_perturb_turbulent_pressure`, so the momentum, work, and reconstructed face states use consistent pressure responses.

A.8 Radiative transport

The face temperature $T_{*,f}$ and spacing $\Delta m_{c,f}$ are defined in Section 2.5. The selected static MLT/RSP2 transport row and its linearization are given there in full.

The spatial gradient used by active TDC is

$$\nabla_{\text{actual},f} = \frac{(T_{k-1} - T_k)/T_{*,f}}{\Delta m_{c,f} (d \ln P / dm)_{\text{QHSE}}}. \quad (\text{A.32})$$

Routine `star_LNA_eval_dlnPdm_qhse` supplies the QHSE derivative, including the selected turbulent-pressure terms. Without those terms it is $-Gm_f/(4\pi r_f^4 P_f)$. The helper starts from the reconstructed EOS pressure when face reconstruction is active, then adds the selected MLT turbulent pressure. The TDC radiative conductance $L_{0,f}$ uses the reconstructed EOS pressure. Without the turbulent-pressure addition, the same EOS pressure therefore enters both expressions.

For the radiation-pressure branch, equation (36) gives the assembled row. The following coefficients define that relation.

The opacity uses `min_kap_for_dPrad_dm_eqn` as a floor. The face state is reconstructed when `use_face_reconstruction` is active. In an MLT cell, L_{rad} is obtained from the background temperature gradient rather than from the total luminosity. With flux limiting,

$$R_f = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f |T_{k-1}^4 - T_k^4|}{\Delta m_f \kappa_f (T_{k-1}^4 + T_k^4)/2}, \quad \lambda_f = \frac{6 + 3R_f}{6 + (3 + R_f)R_f}. \quad (\text{A.33})$$

Without flux limiting, $\lambda_f = 1$.

In `dPrad_dm_resid_for_star_LNA`, Δm_f is normally `s%dm_bar(k)`. At $k = N$ with `R_center > 0`, it is replaced by $\Delta m_{c,f}$, matching the cell-center spacing beside an excised core.

For active TDC, this transport relation supplies the spatial gradient while the single algebraic row remains equation (31). The implementation first obtains

$$L_{\text{rad},f} = -\frac{c\mathcal{A}_f^2 \lambda_f}{\Delta m_f \kappa_f} \frac{a}{3} (T_{k-1}^4 - T_k^4), \quad \nabla_{\text{actual},f} = \frac{L_{\text{rad},f}}{L_{0,f}}, \quad (\text{A.34})$$

and passes this gradient to `set_TDC_LNA`. Thus the TDC luminosity and turbulent-velocity relations use the selected spatial transport equation without adding another unknown or residual row. RSP2 instead inserts its reconstructed L_r directly in equation (36). The TDC helper `actual_gradT_for_star_LNA` still uses `s%dm_bar(k)` in this branch; the explicit inner-spacing replacement above applies to the static MLT/RSP2 row. These paths require separate inner-boundary checks.

B TDC coefficients and reconstructed faces

The global luminosity and amplitude rows are in Sections 2.5 and 2.6. This appendix defines their local coefficients and AD inputs.

The active TDC relation is evaluated by `set_TDC_LNA`. The MESA/star routine `tdc_face_state_for_star_LNA` obtains

$$(T, \rho, P, e, C_P, \chi_\rho, \chi_T, \nabla_{\text{ad}}, \kappa, H_P, \nabla_{\text{rad}})_f \quad (\text{B.1})$$

from `get_reconstructed_face_state_ad`. When `use_face_reconstruction` is true, these are the cached reconstructed EOS and opacity quantities. Otherwise they are the stored face values. They remain automatic differentiation objects in both paths.

The routine `actual_gradT_for_star_LNA` supplies ∇_{actual} . It uses the logarithmic-pressure or QHSE spatial relation normally and equation (A.34) when the model selects `use_dPrad_dm_form_of_T_gradient_eqn`. The QHSE path uses reconstructed face pressure when face reconstruction is active.

The internal velocity variable is

$$A = \frac{v_c}{\sqrt{2/3}}. \quad (\text{B.2})$$

Define

$$L_0 = \frac{16\pi ac}{3} \frac{GmT^4}{P\kappa}, \quad \nabla_r = \frac{L}{L_0}, \quad (\text{B.3})$$

$$Y = \nabla_{\text{actual}} - \nabla_{L,\text{eff}}. \quad (\text{B.4})$$

The default is $\nabla_{L,\text{eff}} = \nabla_L$. With `TDC_use_dynamical_gradL`, `get_TDC_dynamical_gradL` supplies the following instantaneous spatial relation, using its actual local `pressure_gradient_factor`:

$$\text{pressure_gradient_factor}_k = \frac{P_{k-1} - P_k}{\Delta P_{\text{QHSE},k}}, \quad (\text{B.5})$$

$$\nabla_{L,\text{eff},k} = \text{pressure_gradient_factor}_k \nabla_{L,k}. \quad (\text{B.6})$$

Here $\Delta P_{\text{QHSE},k} = -G_k m_{g,k} \Delta m_f / (4\pi r_k^4)$ on the nonrotating, fixed-mass background accepted by LNA, with $\Delta m_f = (\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)/2$. Both TDC and the default one equation RSP2 gradient closure retain the product rule:

$$\begin{aligned} \delta \nabla_{L,\text{eff},k} &= \text{pressure_gradient_factor}_k \delta \nabla_{L,k} \\ &\quad + \nabla_{L,k} \delta \text{pressure_gradient_factor}_k, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{B.7})$$

$$\delta \text{pressure_gradient_factor}_k = \frac{\delta P_{k-1} - \delta P_k}{\Delta P_{\text{QHSE},k}} + 4 \text{pressure_gradient_factor}_k \delta \ln r_k. \quad (\text{B.8})$$

The composition-gradient contribution in ∇_L is a fixed background input to these AD derivatives. In RSP2, `compute_RSP2_gradT` stores this response in `gradT_ad`; the LNA temperature and flux rows use it directly. The optional RSP2 moment model instead uses the row consistent mapping in Appendix D.5. The pressure-ratio perturbation is retained even when its background value is one. The control defaults to false. The helper leaves ∇_L unchanged at the surface, without an active hydro velocity variable, or when the ratio is undefined. It does the same at $k = N$ with `R_center` > 0 if the ratio is nonpositive. Its pressure difference includes the selected MLT turbulent pressure, using `mlt_vc_old` in that coefficient. Its Ledoux support is incomplete: the uncommon `get_brunt_B` fallback already uses the QHSE pressure interval, so its composition contribution receives an extra pressure-ratio factor. The TDC length passed to `set_TDC_LNA` is

$$H_P^* = \begin{cases} H_P, & \beta_h \leq 0, \\ P/(\rho g), & \beta_h > 0, \end{cases} \quad (\text{B.9})$$

$$\Lambda_0 = \alpha_{\text{MLT}} H_P^*, \quad (\text{B.10})$$

$$\Lambda = \begin{cases} \Lambda_0, & \beta_h \leq 0, \\ (\Lambda_0^{-1} + (\beta_h r)^{-1})^{-1}, & \beta_h > 0, \end{cases} \quad (\text{B.11})$$

$$\alpha_{\text{eff}} = \begin{cases} \alpha_{\text{MLT}}, & \beta_h \leq 0, \\ \Lambda/H_P^*, & \beta_h > 0. \end{cases} \quad (\text{B.12})$$

Here `get_mlt_mixing_length` evaluates Λ . Thus the LNA and nonlinear TDC paths differentiate the same harmonic length. The local MLT call supplies Γ . The environmental excess is

$$Y_{\text{env}} = \begin{cases} Y\Gamma/(1 + \Gamma), & Y > 0 \text{ and the MLT correction is enabled,} \\ Y, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (\text{B.13})$$

The TDC call to `set_TDC_LNA` sets the nonlinear enthalpy flux limiter to false. The TDC coefficients are

$$S_0 = \alpha_S x_S \alpha_{\text{eff}} \frac{C_P T}{H_P^*} \nabla_{\text{ad}} Y_{\text{env}} + E_q/w, \quad (\text{B.14})$$

$$D_0 = \frac{\alpha_D x_D}{\Lambda}, \quad (\text{B.15})$$

$$D_{R0} = 4\sigma_{\text{SB}} \left(\frac{\alpha_R x_R}{\Lambda} \right)^2 \frac{T^3}{\rho^2 C_P \kappa}. \quad (\text{B.16})$$

Here $E_q/w = 0$ for the static first order operator. The two algebraic luminosities are

$$L_{\text{rad}} = L_0 \nabla_{\text{actual}}, \quad (\text{B.17})$$

$$L_{\text{conv}} = \alpha_C \alpha_{\text{eff}} \alpha_c \rho T C_P 4\pi r^2 A Y_{\text{env}}, \quad \alpha_c = \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{2}{3}}. \quad (\text{B.18})$$

They enter Equation (31).

The TDC cell eddy-viscosity length is the shared cell-local $\Lambda_{\text{cell},k}$ in Equation (57). Both nonlinear TDC and `tdc_chi_coefficient_for_star_LNA` call `get_TDC_mixing_length_cell`. At a static zero-shear background, the perturbation of the stress coefficient multiplies zero shear, so the first-order viscous force uses its background value times the perturbed velocity shear. Face lengths used by the TDC convection closure and u-grid viscosity retain their face definition.

C RSP2 convection coefficients

These coefficients supply the transport, turbulent-energy, and independent flux rows in Sections 2.5 and 2.7. Their AD values are calculated in `hydro_rsp2.f90` and reused by `star_LNA_turbulence_closures.f90`. The PII, convective luminosity and buoyant source formulas below describe the default one equation model. Appendix D.5 gives their replacements for the optional moment model. Mixing lengths, turbulent pressure, kinetic energy transport and viscosity retain their existing forms.

C.1 Face state and velocity–entropy correlation

RSP2 stores w in cells. Its face value is

$$w_f = a_f w_k + (1 - a_f) w_{k-1}, \quad a_f = \begin{cases} \Delta m_{k-1}/(\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k), & \text{mass interpolation,} \\ 1/2, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (\text{C.1})$$

These are the weights in `get_RSP2_alfa_beta_face_weights`.

PII has units of specific entropy, with the turbulent-speed factor applied separately in luminosity and source. With $x_S = x_C = \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{2/3}$, `compute_PII_from_Y` evaluates

$$\text{PII}_f = x_S \frac{\Lambda_f}{Hp_f} C_{P,f} Y_f, \quad Y_f = \nabla_f - \nabla_{L,\text{eff},f}. \quad (\text{C.2})$$

Hp and Λ come from the shared TDC length functions. The ratio Λ/Hp cannot in general be replaced by α_{MLT} when harmonic lengths are selected. PII is zero at $k = 1, N$ and in the selected forced-nonturbulent face region.

The same signed PII enters convective luminosity and buoyant driving. Its perturbation is the product rule

$$\begin{aligned} \delta \text{PII}_f &= x_S \frac{\Lambda_f}{Hp_f} C_{P,f} \delta Y_f \\ &+ x_S Y_f \left[\frac{C_{P,f}}{Hp_f} \delta \Lambda_f + \frac{\Lambda_f}{Hp_f} \delta C_{P,f} - \frac{\Lambda_f C_{P,f}}{Hp_f^2} \delta Hp_f \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.3})$$

This form remains regular at $Y_f = 0$ and retains the response for either sign of Y . Nonlinear hydro and RSP2 LNA use the same `PII_ad`; face weights are held fixed during the perturbation. There is no local inversion of luminosity to recover Y .

C.2 Radiative, convective, and turbulent fluxes

The gradient is now evaluated directly:

$$\nabla_f = \nabla_{L,\text{eff},f} + Y_f, \quad \delta \nabla_f = \delta \nabla_{L,\text{eff},f} + \delta Y_f. \quad (\text{C.4})$$

`compute_Lrad_coeff`, `compute_Lc_terms`, and `compute_Lt` then supply

$$L_{r,f} = \text{Lrad_coeff}_f \nabla_f, \quad \text{Lrad_coeff}_f = \mathcal{A}_f \frac{4acT_f^4}{3\kappa_f \rho_f Hp_f}, \quad (\text{C.5})$$

$$L_{c,f} = \mathcal{A}_f w_f \frac{x_C}{x_S} (\rho T)_f \text{PII}_f, \quad (\text{C.6})$$

$$L_{t,k} = -\alpha_t \mathcal{A}_k^2 (\rho^2)_f \Lambda_f w_f \frac{w_{k-1}^2 - w_k^2}{\text{dm_bar}(\mathbf{k})}. \quad (\text{C.7})$$

The products $(\rho T)_f$ and $(\rho^2)_f$ are interpolated products, not products of separately averaged quantities. The inward turbulent flux at the physical inner boundary and the surface turbulent flux are zero. The existing forced-nonturbulent masks are retained. The flux residual differentiates these expressions directly. For example,

$$\delta L_r = \text{Lrad_coeff} (\delta \nabla_{L,\text{eff}} + \delta Y) + \nabla \delta \text{Lrad_coeff}. \quad (\text{C.8})$$

At fixed structure and nonnegative w , convective luminosity has a nonnegative Y derivative and the radiative term has a positive Y derivative. This local property does not prove convergence of the coupled stellar solve. TDC retains its own convection relation and viscosity routines.

C.3 Cell source and damping

Using the actual cell EOS quantities, the buoyant source is

$$\text{Source}_k = (w_k + w_{\text{seed}}) \left\langle \frac{\text{PII}}{Hp} \right\rangle_k \frac{P_{\text{eos},k} \chi_{T,k}}{\rho_k \chi_{\rho,k} C_{P,k}}, \quad (\text{C.9})$$

where the bracket is half the sum at the two bounding faces for $k < N$, and the single available ratio at $k = N$. The source uses cell w after averaging the face PII/H_p . It does not average $w \text{PII}/H_p$ from faces; with zero seed it vanishes when the cell w is zero, even if an adjacent cell carries convection. With $x_D = (8/3)\sqrt{2/3}$ and $x_R = 2\sqrt{3}$, the damping terms are

$$D_k = \alpha_d x_D \frac{w_k^3}{\Lambda_{\text{cell},k}}, \quad (\text{C.10})$$

$$D_{r,k} = 4\sigma_{\text{SB}}(\alpha_r x_R)^2 \frac{w_k^2 T_k^3}{\rho_k^2 C_{P,k} \kappa_k \Lambda_{\text{cell},k}^2}. \quad (\text{C.11})$$

These are `compute_Source`, `compute_D`, and `compute_Dr`. The LNA coupling wrapper uses those routines and returns $C = \text{COUPL} = \text{Source} - D - D_r$. The former independently calculated cell H_p is not used in damping.

D Eddy viscosity: both grids and both work forms

TDC viscosity is implemented in `tdc_hydro.f90`; RSP2 viscosity is in `hydro_rsp2.f90`. Only the scale-height and mixing-length functions are shared. This keeps RSP2 cell w separate from TDC face $v_c/\sqrt{2/3}$. The static LNA uses the equilibrium stress coefficients described below.

D.1 Face velocity: cell stress

For face velocity v , both models use $\Lambda_{\text{cell},k}$, but the stress velocity is w_k in RSP2 and $(v_{c,k} + v_{c,k+1})/(2\sqrt{2/3})$ in TDC. Only half the available TDC face value is used at the innermost cell. The cell stress is

$$Chi_k = \frac{16\pi}{3} \frac{\alpha_m \rho_k^2}{\Delta m_k} \frac{r_k^6 + r_{k+1}^6}{2} \Lambda_{\text{cell},k} w_{\text{stress},k} \left(\frac{v_k}{r_k} - \frac{v_{k+1}}{r_{k+1}} \right). \quad (\text{D.1})$$

Here w_{stress} denotes the placement just specified; it is not a new solver variable. Since the background strain is zero, only the velocity variation contributes to δChi at first order. Then

$$\delta U q_k = \frac{4\pi}{r_k \Delta m_{\text{face},k}} (\delta Chi_{k-1} - \delta Chi_k). \quad (\text{D.2})$$

The dual mass is $(\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)/2$ for $k > 1$ and $\Delta m_1/2$ at the surface. The exterior stress is zero. Nonlinear RSP2 also retains the native mass-correction factors in this dual mass; LNA does not support those factors. *Code:* `compute_Chi_cell`, `compute_Uq_face`, and the LNA `static_eddy_Chi_cell_for_star_LNA/static_eddy_Uq_face_for_star_LNA`.

D.2 Cell velocity: face stress

For `u_flag`, RSP2 interpolates its cell w to the face using its own face weights. TDC uses its stored face $v_c/\sqrt{2/3}$. The face stress is

$$Chi_{f,k} = \frac{16\pi}{3} \frac{\alpha_m \rho_{f,k}^2}{\Delta m_{\text{face},k}} r_k^6 \Lambda_{f,k} w_{f,k} \left(\frac{u_{k-1}}{r_{\text{mid,start},k-1}} - \frac{u_k}{r_{\text{mid,start},k}} \right). \quad (\text{D.3})$$

The nonlinear force is

$$\Delta m_k U q_k = \frac{4\pi}{r_{\text{mid,start},k}} (Chi_{f,k} - Chi_{f,k+1}). \quad (\text{D.4})$$

RSP2 `compute_Uq_dm_cell` returns this force. The Riemann momentum row divides it by `dm` exactly once; it is not added to the contact velocity. On the static background, the corresponding LNA term is

$$\delta U q_k = \frac{4\pi}{r_{\text{mid},k} \Delta m_k} (\delta \text{Chi}_{f,k} - \delta \text{Chi}_{f,k+1}). \quad (\text{D.5})$$

Code: `static_eddy_Chi_face_for_star_LNA` and `Uq_cell_for_star_LNA`. Density, length, and w perturbations multiply zero background strain, so their products have no first-order contribution.

The surface face stress is zero. A positive `R_center` permits an inner boundary stress when `TDC_include_inner_boundary_eddy_viscosity` is true. RSP2 also requires an empty inner forced-nonturbulent region. It uses R_{center} , ρ_N , $\Lambda_{f,N}$, and mass $\Delta m_N/2$. Its turbulent velocity is the innermost cell w for RSP2, and $v_{c,N}/\sqrt{2/3}$ for TDC. The strain is $u_N/r_{\text{mid,start},N} - v_{\text{center}}/R_{\text{center}}$; the prescribed inner velocity has zero perturbation. A temperature-selected LNA domain does not create this physical boundary.

D.3 Nonlinear heating and the work identity

Use the same stress in momentum and heating. On the v grid,

$$Eq_k = \frac{4\pi \text{Chi}_k}{\Delta m_k} \left(\frac{v_k^{\text{work}}}{r_k^{\text{work}}} - \frac{v_{k+1}^{\text{work}}}{r_{k+1}^{\text{work}}} \right). \quad (\text{D.6})$$

On the u grid, first evaluate the face-specific heating,

$$Eq_{f,k} = \frac{4\pi \text{Chi}_{f,k}}{\Delta m_{\text{face},k}} \left(\frac{u_{k-1}^{\text{work}}}{r_{\text{mid,start},k-1}} - \frac{u_k^{\text{work}}}{r_{\text{mid,start},k}} \right), \quad (\text{D.7})$$

$$Eq_k = \frac{1}{2} (Eq_{f,k} + Eq_{f,k+1}). \quad (\text{D.8})$$

The half-face allocation sums to the full dual mass on an unequal-mass mesh. The inner-boundary face has its own half-cell mass and prescribed velocity. Summation by parts gives

$$\sum_k \Delta m_{\text{face},k} v_k^{\text{work}} U q_k + \sum_k \Delta m_k Eq_k = -4\pi \text{Chi}_N v_{\text{center}} / R_{\text{center}}, \quad v \text{ grid}, \quad (\text{D.9})$$

$$\sum_k \Delta m_k u_k^{\text{work}} U q_k + \sum_k \Delta m_k Eq_k = -4\pi \text{Chi}_{f,N+1} v_{\text{center}} / R_{\text{center}}, \quad u \text{ grid}. \quad (\text{D.10})$$

The right sides vanish for zero boundary stress or velocity. For a full center, these expressions are understood by the zero-stress limit, not division by zero. RSP2 masks stresses at the selected forced regions and retains their force divergence at the interface. TDC retains its existing additional momentum masks; the unrestricted identity is not asserted across those masks.

The four `dedt` cases have distinct energy-source terms:

Grid	Local PdV	Energy source from viscosity	Explicit mechanical inertia
v	true	Eq_k	none
v	false	$Eq_k + \frac{1}{2}(\bar{v}_k U q_k + \bar{v}_{k+1} U q_{k+1})$	$K + \Phi$
u	true	Eq_k	none
u	false	$Eq_k + \bar{u}_k U q_k$	$K + \Phi$

Here $\bar{v} = (v + v_{\text{start}})/2$ and similarly for u . The v -grid power also includes the native cell mass-correction factor when enabled in nonlinear hydro. Conservative work always uses these averaged

velocities, including when optional velocity time centering is off. For local PdV work, heating uses the average only if velocity time centering is on; otherwise it uses the current velocity. The latter is a current-velocity power identity, not exact finite-step kinetic-energy change. RSP2 `eps_grav` retains Eq but no explicit Uq power or mechanical inertia, for either setting of the work control.

TDC's explicit-momentum option uses old convective velocity in momentum and current velocity in heating. This intentionally distinct choice is unchanged; same-stress cancellation then has a lag difference. RSP2 uses current cell w in both terms and does not inherit that TDC option.

D.4 Static energy order

On a zero-velocity background, $Uq = O(\delta)$ and $Eq = O(\delta^2)$. Thus

$$\delta(vUq) = \delta(uUq) = 0, \quad \delta Eq = 0. \quad (\text{D.11})$$

`turbulent_viscous_heating_for_star_LNA` returns zero, while the first-order Uq response remains in momentum. The nonlinear work comparisons above therefore explain conservation without introducing additional LNA rows.

D.5 Optional three equation closure and discretization

Pi and PII. PII has units of specific entropy. Pi has units of specific entropy times velocity. The old luminosity is $L_{c,f} = \mathcal{A}_f(\rho T)_f w_f \text{PII}_f$, whereas the new closure is

$$L_{c,f} = \mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f \text{Pi}_f, \quad (\text{D.12})$$

$$\delta L_{c,f} = \mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f \delta \text{Pi}_f + \text{Pi}_f \delta(\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f). \quad (\text{D.13})$$

Pi replaces the algebraic heat transport closure. PII is not another solver variable in this mode. Its retained diagnostic is Pi_f/w_f when $w_f > 0$, and zero when both vanish. When creating missing moments at an unforced, unstable face with positive old L_c , the initial Pi is that luminosity divided by the new $\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f$; different face interpolations mean this need not equal the old $w_f \text{PII}_f$. The initial variance is $3\text{Pi}_f^2/(2e_{t,f})$ for positive face energy. Other faces start with zero Pi and Phi, retaining their turbulent energy. This initial-state assumption preserves the imported heat flux only at the selected unstable faces; it does not assert moment equilibrium or modify an existing three equation restart state.

Face state, source and cooling. The new closure uses the common reconstructed face EOS when enabled, or the selected RSP2 face weights for each EOS quantity. Buoyancy uses the resolved cell pressure difference:

$$\left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho}\right)_f = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f(P_k - P_{k-1})}{(\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)/2}. \quad (\text{D.14})$$

The cell source reconstructs the correlation with the local cell velocity:

$$S_k = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{f=k,k+1} \frac{w_k}{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}} \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho}\right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \text{Pi}_f. \quad (\text{D.15})$$

Forced faces contribute zero. A zero energy face with zero Pi contributes zero without division; nonzero Pi at zero face energy is invalid. The reconstruction makes the source vanish in an empty

cell without removing moment evolution at its interface with a turbulent neighbor. The cooling rate and two new coefficients are

$$\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} = \frac{4\sigma_{\text{SB}}(\alpha_R x_R)^2 T_f^3}{C_{P,f} \kappa_f \rho_f^2 \Lambda_f^2}, \quad \alpha_{\text{Pi}} = 6\sqrt{2/3}, \quad \alpha_{\text{Phi}} = 4\sqrt{2/3}. \quad (\text{D.16})$$

The alpha symbols are the effective coefficients. In source they are `RSP2_alfa_pi*x_ALFAPHI` and `RSP2_alfa_phi*x_ALFAPHI`; the two controls default to one, and the fixed factors above are stored in `hydro_rsp2`. These are the local MLT calibration listed in [Braun et al. \(2026\)](#), section 2, not that paper's fitted solar coefficients. The factor of two in variance cooling follows from evolving the full $\langle s'^2 \rangle$.

The normalization of the two existing controls is

$$\gamma_r = 2\sqrt{3} \text{RSP2_alfar}, \quad \alpha_\omega = \text{RSP2_alfat}. \quad (\text{D.17})$$

[Braun et al. \(2026\)](#), Table 1, list $\gamma_r = 3.46$ and $\alpha_\omega = 0.25$. These correspond to `RSP2_alfar=1d0` and `RSP2_alfat=0.25d0`; the present defaults are both zero. The cooling rate scales as `RSP2_alfar` squared. Its physical role changes with the model: the default model loses cell turbulent energy through $D_r = e_t/\tau_{\text{rad}}$, while the three equation model cools face Pi and Phi at rates $1/\tau_{\text{rad}}$ and $2/\tau_{\text{rad}}$ and has no direct D_r . Alfat controls kinetic energy diffusion with coefficient $\alpha_\omega \Lambda \sqrt{e_t}$ in both models. There is no extra $\sqrt{2/3}$ in its coefficient and no added transport of Pi or Phi. Matching coefficients does not make the face interpolation, mixing length prescription or complete models identical.

Entropy driving and the temperature row. `get_rsp2_thermal_gradient` maps the selected temperature relation to its radial thermal differential. At uniform composition,

$$(-\partial_r s)_f = C_{P,f} [(-\partial_r \ln T)_{\text{row},f} - \nabla_{\text{ad},f} (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{actual},f}]. \quad (\text{D.18})$$

The QHSE and radiation pressure forms use the EOS differential

$$(-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{actual},f} = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f (P_k - P_{k-1})}{\Delta m_{c,f} P_f}. \quad (\text{D.19})$$

The logarithmic row uses its actual logarithmic pressure difference instead. For QHSE, the coefficient multiplying ∇_T is $-\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f h_f T_{*,f}/T_f$; for radiation pressure it is $\rho_f \kappa_f L_{r,\text{coeff},f}/(4c \mathcal{A}_f \lambda_f P_{\text{rad},f})$. The logarithmic row uses $\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f \ln(P_k/P_{k-1})/\Delta m_{c,f}$. The radiation coefficient, opacity floor and boundary spacing are shared with the actual temperature row.

For the first two forms, define the neutral gradient using the selected reference pressure differential and the temperature coefficient just given. Dynamic gradL uses the actual pressure differential; static gradL uses the HSE pressure differential. The algebraically equivalent evaluation is

$$\begin{aligned} (-\partial_r s)_f = C_{P,f} [& (-\partial_r \ln T)_{\nabla_T=1,f} Y_f + B_f (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{ref},f} \\ & + \nabla_{\text{ad},f} \{ (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{ref},f} - (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{actual},f} \}]. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{D.20})$$

Here B_f is the existing composition contribution to gradL. The dynamic branch cancels the last difference analytically. The logarithmic form uses $\nabla_L = \nabla_{\text{ad}} + B$ and $(-\partial_r s) = C_P (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\log}(Y + B)$. All current structure derivatives are retained; the existing composition coefficient is held fixed in thermal AD. These algebraic cancellations change neither implicitness nor luminosity time weights. Nonlinear `constant_L` retains a measured entropy differential; LNA still excludes that temperature row.

Mean velocity strain. For cell velocity, the face strain is $\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f (u_{k-1} - u_k) / \Delta m_{c,f}$. For face velocity it is

$$(\partial_r v)_f = a_f \frac{v_k - v_{k+1}}{r_k - r_{k+1}} + (1 - a_f) \frac{v_{k-1} - v_k}{r_{k-1} - r_k}. \quad (\text{D.21})$$

The latter is exact for an affine radial velocity on an unequal grid. It is a deformation term in Pi evolution, with no new viscosity coefficient.

Nonlinear residuals and normalization. Each moment row is its current value minus its accepted value minus Δt times its current rhs, divided by a fixed start scale. Using the same positive luminosity scale L_{scale} as the flux row,

$$\text{Pi}_{\text{ref}} = L_{\text{scale}} / (\mathcal{A} \rho T), \quad v_{\text{ref}} = [L_{\text{scale}} / (\mathcal{A} \rho)]^{1/3}, \quad (\text{D.22})$$

$$\text{Pi}_{\text{scale}} = \max(|\text{Pi}_{\text{start}}|, \text{Pi}_{\text{ref}}), \quad \text{Phi}_{\text{scale}} = \max(\text{Phi}_{\text{start}}, \frac{3}{2} [\text{Pi}_{\text{ref}} / v_{\text{ref}}]^2). \quad (\text{D.23})$$

These also scale the new solver columns. They impose no bound on Pi. The one-equation RSP2 model retains the original normalized turbulent energy residual for nonzero accepted energy. The three-equation model multiplies that residual by $\max(1, c_s/w)$. For $0 < w < c_s$, known factors of w are canceled term by term before differentiation. In particular, $(w^2 - w_{\text{start}}^2)/w = w - w_{\text{start}}^2/w$ retains its derivative $1 + (w_{\text{start}}/w)^2$, and the explicit numerator w cancels from the buoyancy source. Face energy and all remaining state derivatives are retained. Face transport and u grid stress use the exact ratio $[aw + (1 - a)w_{\text{neighbor}}]/w = a + (1 - a)w_{\text{neighbor}}/w$; accepted energy, pressure and flux terms remain divided by current w . Remaining quotients use $q = x/w$, $\delta q = (\delta x - q \delta w)/w$, avoiding an intermediate $1/w^2$ that can overflow at tiny w . Physical equations and time weights are unchanged. At a stationary positive energy background, scaling both stiffness and inertia preserves the LNA eigenvalues. The zero energy branch is selected as described with the moment equations. The companion RSP3 manuscript gives the complete divided row. At a factorizable zero accepted energy, the analytic canceled row selects the zero or positive branch in either model. The three-equation divided row retains a positive trial value when accepted energy or surviving moments require it. The energy test includes exact underflow of w_{start}^2 to zero; positive representable history is retained. No denominator floor is used. The positive multiplier is at least one, so meeting the scaled residual tolerance also meets the original normalized energy tolerance.

The local isotropic closure does not guarantee $\text{Pi}_f^2 \leq (2/3) e_{t,f} \text{Phi}_f$. Independent interpolation and kinetic energy transport do not establish that bound either. The covariance excess profile reports the difference; it does not limit heat flux. The two new moment perturbations are included in LNA eigenfunction output, and setup reports their dimensional equilibrium defects.

E Mode and work conventions

Finite positive frequency roots are sorted by increasing ω . The selected list applies the frequency floor and the existing growth controls to

$$g_{\ln K} = \text{logKE_per_cycle} = \frac{4\pi\gamma}{\omega}. \quad (\text{E.1})$$

This is logarithmic kinetic energy growth per cycle, not a generic GYRE η . Derived output quantities are

$$\frac{\Delta K}{K} = \exp(g_{\ln K}) - 1, \quad (\text{E.2})$$

$$\text{GREKM} = 2 \tanh(g_{\ln K}/2), \quad (\text{E.3})$$

$$\frac{\Delta a}{a} = \exp(g_{\ln K}/2) - 1. \quad (\text{E.4})$$

The old `star_LNA*_eta` identifiers are retained for inlist compatibility, but comments and files state that they filter `logKE_per_cycle`.

The optional velocity initialization combines the selected complex velocity eigenfunctions. For mode j , the surface-phase normalization is

$$\widehat{\delta v_{j,k}} = \frac{\delta v_{j,k}}{\delta v_{j,1}}. \quad (\text{E.5})$$

The requested fractions are applied to these normalized eigenfunctions, and the real velocity is scaled to `star_LNA_kick_vsurf_km_per_sec` at the surface. This preserves the computed velocity phase and amplitude instead of constructing a velocity profile from displacement amplitudes. With `u_flag`, the active eigenfunction is cell velocity. The kick updates its solver state and rebuilds the Riemann face velocities and their start values. Only the velocity state is initialized.

Pressure work is reported with the RSP phase convention

$$W_{P,k} = -\pi \Delta m_k \text{Im}(\delta P_k^* \delta \nu_k), \quad (\text{E.6})$$

where $\nu = 1/\rho$ is specific volume and $\delta \nu_k = -\delta \ln \rho_k / \rho_k$. The result is divided by the modal kinetic energy normalization. EOS and RSP2 turbulent pressure perturbations use the same closure as the operator. The eddy viscosity and luminosity terms have not been compared with RSP/RSP2 work output. The reported `total_work` is an arithmetic sum of six diagnostics: EOS pressure, turbulent pressure, eddy viscosity, and radiative, convective, and turbulent luminosity work. These six quantities have not been derived and validated as one discrete work balance against Equation (E.1). Pressure work and luminosity-based thermal diagnostics need not represent independent energy exchanges, so their simple addition is not an established decomposition of net modal driving. A consistent work identity should provide an independent check of the eigenvalue growth. This limitation of the postprocessing does not itself establish an error in the eigenvalue.

Routine `eddy_viscous_work_for_star_LNA` uses the acceleration from the same momentum operator. Before division by modal kinetic energy,

$$W_{q,k} = \frac{\pi \Delta m_k}{|\omega|} \begin{cases} \text{Re}(\delta u_k^* \delta U_{q,k}), & \text{u_flag,} \\ \frac{1}{2} \text{Re}(\delta v_k^* \delta U_{q,k} + \delta v_{k+1}^* \delta U_{q,k+1}), & \text{face velocity.} \end{cases} \quad (\text{E.7})$$

Perturbations below the active domain are zero. The normalization is $K = \frac{1}{2} \sum_k \Delta m_{v,k} |\delta v_{\text{rad},k}|^2$, using cell masses for u and `star_LNA_dm_face` for v .

F Schema 130 TDC background export

When `gyre_data_schema = 130` and `gyre_write_tdc_lna_background = .true.`, `star/private/pulse_gyre.f90` writes the standard schema-120 columns 1 through 19 followed by the columns

in Table 1. The exporter writes background data only; it does not run GYRE or define GYRE’s perturbation equations.

Schema 130 does not carry the harmonic TDC mixing length. When `harmonic_dissipation_length_beta` is positive, MESA writes a warning and still exports the legacy `mixing_length_alpha` and `Hp_face` fields. The legacy length represented by these fields is

$$\Lambda_{\text{GYRE}} = \alpha_{\text{MLT}} H_P, \quad (\text{F.1})$$

which differs from the harmonic Λ used by MESA. This describes the MESA exporter; changes in a separate GYRE checkout do not change the STAR LNA operator or this file schema.

Table 1: Additional schema 130 point columns.

Column	Source quantity	Meaning
20	<code>L_conv</code>	background convective luminosity $L_{c,0}$
21	<code>mlt_vc/sqrt_2_div_3</code>	TDC amplitude A_0
22	<code>i_tdc_d_conv_h</code>	inferred diffusivity D_{conv}
23	<code>Hp_face</code>	face pressure scale height
24	<code>mixing_length_alpha</code>	α_{MLT}
25	<code>Cp_face</code>	face specific heat
26	<code>chiT_face</code>	χ_T
27	<code>chiRho_face</code>	χ_ρ
28	<code>gradL</code>	Ledoux gradient
29	<code>gradT</code>	actual temperature gradient
30 through 35	TDC controls	$\alpha_C, \alpha_S, \alpha_D, \alpha_R, \alpha_{Pt}, \alpha_M$
36	logical as real	include the MLT correction
37	<code>mlt_Pturb_factor</code>	MLT turbulent pressure factor
38	inferred	background MLT turbulent pressure

The exported diffusivity is inferred by `store_tdc_lna_point_env` from

$$F_{\text{conv}} = \rho T C_P D_{\text{conv}} \frac{\nabla_T - \nabla_L}{H_P}, \quad (\text{F.2})$$

so

$$D_{\text{conv}} = \frac{L_{\text{conv}} H_P}{4\pi r^2 \rho T C_P (\nabla_T - \nabla_L)} \quad (\text{F.3})$$

when the denominator and L_{conv} are positive. Its units are $\text{cm}^2 \text{s}^{-1}$; the earlier label $D_{\text{conv}} H_P$ was inconsistent with this equation and the exporter. The exported turbulent pressure is

$$P_{\text{t,MLT},0} = f_{\text{Pt}} \frac{\rho f_c^2}{3}. \quad (\text{F.4})$$

G Audit files and restrictions

With `star_LNA_write_matrix_summary = .true.`, the source writes

- `<prefix>_matrix_summary.data`, including matrix dimensions, nonzero counts, norm ranges, residuals, and equation counts;
- `<prefix>_row_structure.data`, including the equation name, nonzero counts, and dominant A/B variable for every row;

- `<prefix>rsp2_term_audit.data` on RSP2 backgrounds, including PII, L_c , L_t , source, damping, radiative damping, turbulent pressure work coefficient, divergences, RHS, and inertia; and
- `<prefix>tdc_face_audit.data` for active TDC, including active and stored face states, background convection quantities, closure luminosities, velocity RHS, and inertia.

When the full-pencil residual rejects a root that otherwise passes the mode heuristics, the terminal output identifies the first such period and its maximum-residual row, zone, and row variable.

The source has the following restrictions:

- no rotation, RTI, mass correction, or velocity drag;
- no `use_compression_outer_BC`, `constant_L`, user `other_*`;
- `eps_grav` is supported only for RSP2; no nonzero `mstar_dot`;
- active RSP2 or MLT turbulent pressure with `u_flag` requires `star_LNA_perturb_turbulent_pressure` to be true;
- the optional initial velocity kick requires `v_flag` or `u_flag`; the `u_flag` path rebuilds the Riemann face velocity and initializes its start-of-step state;
- RSP2 requires `star_LNA_convection_treatment = 'perturbed'`;
- no derivative of the nonlinear enthalpy flux limiter in the TDC operator;
- dense all roots scaling with model zone count;
- the six-column `total_work` diagnostic is not a derived discrete work balance against the eigenvalue growth.

`check_star_LNA_model` rejects incompatible controls. Setup output lists accepted controls that alter the linearization. The existing three-zone AD stencil can drop farther-neighbor derivatives after shifts; the assembled operator retains that supported stencil, rather than an unrestricted full-band derivative of every composite closure.

H Surface boundary details and source map

H.1 Atmospheric boundary offsets

The ordinary atmospheric temperature condition uses

$$T_{bc} = T_{atm} + \Delta T_0, \quad \Delta T_0 = \Delta P_0 \frac{\nabla_1 T_1}{P_{eos,1}}, \quad (H.1)$$

$$\Delta P_0 = \frac{G_1 m_{g,1} \Delta m_1}{8\pi r_1^4}. \quad (H.2)$$

The offset is retained for both choices of `use_momentum_outer_BC` and differentiated with AD. At fixed mass and composition,

$$\delta \Delta T_0 = \frac{\Delta P_0 T_1}{P_{eos,1}} \delta \nabla_1 + \Delta T_0 [-4\delta \ln r_1 + (1 - \chi_{T,1})\delta \ln T_1 - \chi_{\rho,1}\delta \ln \rho_1], \quad (H.3)$$

$$\delta \ln T_{bc} = \frac{T_{atm} \delta \ln T_{atm} + \delta \Delta T_0}{T_{atm} + \Delta T_0}. \quad (H.4)$$

The atmosphere supplies $\delta \ln T_{\text{atm}}$, including its supported opacity, luminosity, and radius responses. This is the boundary variation used in the surface-temperature row in Section 2.9.

When `use_momentum_outer_BC` and `floor_momentum_outer_BC_at_Prads` are true, the momentum boundary uses

$$P_{\text{bc}} = \max(P_{\text{bc}}^{\text{raw}}, aT_{\text{atm}}^4/3). \quad (\text{H.5})$$

On the floored branch, $\delta \ln P_{\text{bc}} = 4\delta \ln T_{\text{atm}}$; otherwise the pre-floor pressure response is retained. Momentum pressure remains at the outer face, while the temperature offset places the temperature at the center of cell 1. The luminosity boundary in Section 2.9 uses no atmospheric temperature offset.

Nonlinear surface-row details. The RSP2-specific switch defaults to true; the shared switch defaults to false. With both off, the normal atmosphere temperature condition applies. The separate `constant_L` override is rejected by STAR LNA. The nonlinear RSP2 row, `do1_rsp2_L_eqn`, uses current area $4\pi r_1^2$ and normalizes by $\max(|L_{r,1}|, |L_1|, 1 \text{ erg s}^{-1})$; $L_{c,1} = L_{t,1} = 0$. The shared `set_RSP_Lsurf_BC` uses `maxval(L_start)` and, when velocity time centering is active, the area

$$\mathcal{A}_1^{\text{hydro}} = \frac{4\pi}{3} (r_1^2 + r_1 r_{1,\text{start}} + r_{1,\text{start}}^2). \quad (\text{H.6})$$

Thus the two nonlinear rows can differ during a step. Their static boundary values agree; the continuous LNA uses current area and the linearized row above, without finite-step centering. The additional RSP2 surface row remains $Y_1 = 0$ and does not duplicate this luminosity boundary.

H.2 Source files

The row routines cited in the main text are in the following files:

- `star/private/star_LNA.f90`, for the public solve flow and row assembly order;
- `star/private/star_LNA_support.f90`, for rows, matrix construction, algebraic elimination, mode output, work output, and audits;
- `star/private/star_LNA_turbulence_closures.f90`, for RSP2 and TDC pressure, luminosity, turbulent energy, and eddy viscosity closures;
- `star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90`, for the independent-Y residual, PII closure, shared-length calls, and RSP2 viscosity;
- `star/private/tdc_hydro.f90`, for the shared lengths and unchanged TDC viscosity;
- `star/private/turb_support.f90`, for the shared dynamical neutral gradient;
- `star/private/hydro_temperature.f90` and `star/private/hydro_eqns.f90`, for nonlinear temperature rows and surface-boundary selection;
- `star/private/hydro_energy.f90` and `star/private/eps_grav.f90`, for nonlinear energy forms;
- `star/private/hydro_riemann.f90` and `star/private/auto_diff_support.f90`, for cell momentum and reconstructed face variables;
- `star/private/star_utils.f90`, for discrete mechanical energies;
- `turb/public/turb.f90`, routine `set_TDC_LNA`, for the local TDC relation; and
- `star/private/pulse_gyre.f90`, for the schema 130 TDC background export.